

spawn-animals and spawn-npcs=false removes all villagers and prevents summoning new mobs

MC-379 Mob spawning

Status	Resolved / Fixed
Affected	Minecraft 1.4.2, 20w14a, 1.16.3, 21w05b, 21w06a, 21w07a (+37 more)
Fixed in	24w33a
Reported	2012-10-25

STEPS TO REPRODUCE

1. Run a Minecraft server.
2. Set ``spawn-npcs=false``, ``spawn-animals=false``, and ``spawn-monsters=false`` in ``server.properties``.
3. Set the server difficulty to a non-peaceful difficulty.
4. Join the server.
5. Execute ``/summon villager``.
6. Execute ``/summon wolf``.
7. Execute ``/summon zombie``.
8. Observe that the zombie remains in the world, while the villager and wolf disappear immediately.

OBSERVED BEHAVIOUR

Actual behavior

With ``spawn-npcs=false``, villagers are removed from the world, including villagers that already existed before the setting was changed. Villagers spawned afterward using ``/summon`` or a spawn egg also disappear immediately.

With ``spawn-animals=false``, passive animals are prevented from persisting when spawned through commands or spawn eggs. For example, a wolf summoned with ``/summon wolf`` disappears immediately.

This behavior also affects mob spawning methods other than natural spawning, such as commands, spawn eggs, and mob spawners. In contrast, with the server difficulty set to a non-Peaceful mode, a zombie summoned with ``/summon zombie`` remains in the world even when ``spawn-monsters=false``.

Thus, ``spawn-npcs`` and ``spawn-animals`` do not only prevent natural spawning; they also remove existing entities and prevent newly summoned or placed villagers and passive animals from remaining in the world.

EXPECTED BEHAVIOUR

With ``spawn-npcs=false`` and ``spawn-animals=false``, villagers and animals should stop spawning naturally, but existing villagers and animals should remain in the world. Players should still be able to create villagers and animals using ``/summon``, spawn eggs, or mob spawners, while hostile mobs should continue behaving according to the difficulty and their respective settings.

ENVIRONMENT

Minecraft Java Edition Versions: 1.4.2, 20w14a, 1.16.3, 21w05b, 21w06a, 21w07a, 21w08a, 21w08b, 21w10a, 21w11a, 21w13a, 21w14a, 21w15a, 21w16a, 21w17a, 21w18a, 21w19a, 21w20a, 1.17 Pre-release 1, 1.17 Pre-release 2, 1.17 Pre-release 3, 1.17 Pre-release 4, 1.17 Pre-release 5, 1.17, 1.17.1, 21w37a, 21w38a, 21w39a, 21w40a, 21w41a, 21w43a, 1.18, 1.18.1, 22w06a, 1.18.2, 22w13a, 22w16b, 1.19 Pre-release 4, 1.19.3, 23w03a, 23w04a, 1.20.4, 24w12a (includes snapshots)

ORIGINAL DESCRIPTION

Setting `spawn-npcs=false` in `server.properties` disables villagers completely

Setting `spawn-animals=false` prevents any mob from being spawned by commands or mob spawners.

What I expected to happen was...

Villagers and animals to stop naturally spawning.

Mobs to still be allowed to be summoned via commands

What actually happened was...

ALL Villagers, including pre-existing ones in the world, or ones newly placed via spawn eggs, disappear instantly.

Steps to Reproduce:

- Run a server
- Change server.properties to:
spawn-npcs=false
spawn-animals=false
spawn-monsters=false
- Join the server and execute the following commands
/summon villager
/summon wolf
/summon zombie

With difficulty on non-peaceful, you can see the Zombie summons fine. But the Villager and Wolf do not stay in the world.

For custom maps, commands should override any server.properties as it does with hostile mobs.

MANUAL RESULT

Version used	
Reproduced?	YES / NO / PARTIAL
Crash file	
Notes	
Tested by / date	

Live issue: <https://bugs.mojang.com/browse/MC/issues/MC-379>